

Learning How to Learn: The Decision

学会学习：决定

Theme: 学习方法与教育 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The test the group could not control arrived as a single sheet of paper. A regional **reading** survey would include their method, and the **administration** wanted a decision by the end of the **quarter**. “**None** of us can **tell** how this will end,” Maya said. “We can only decide what to send.” A **grey drawing** of the **reading tank** — their own childish sketch — lay on the table beside the official form, and every line of it looked wrong.

The **population** of the survey was a million students, and their sample was a few hundred. “To be **frank**, that is a **lot** of noise,” the **principal** said. “Your **best** hope is a quite small, clean result.” Each of them knew it already. Every **classification** has an edge, and theirs was the edge of the page. The least they could do was say so in advance.

They decided to send the method itself, not the results. A **vertical line**, a **signature**, a **stamp**, and a bundle of **cord** went into one parcel, which looked like a **costume** rather than a proposal. “If the survey finds nothing,” Lin wrote, “that is a **confirmation**, not a disaster.” A **spark** of doubt remained, but the **chorus** of agreement was louder than the doubt.

They discussed the wording for an hour. To **throw** the old version away was tempting, but a **continuation** is not a rejection; it is a **steel beam** added under a wooden floor. “**Browse** the appendix,” Maya said. “A **panda**, a **wolf**, and a **dragon** in a child’s **drawing** taught us more than the survey ever will.” The **tap** dripped, and nobody moved to close it.

A **slip** of **white** paper, a **leaf** from an **organic** farm, a **pound** of spare paper, and a small bottle of **liquid** were their **belongings** on the last night of the term. “You are the **hero** of your own report,” Professor Zhao said, “and that is exactly the problem.” Several of them sat in silence; some smiled at the other volunteers. “**Granted**, you have very little time,” she went on. “But a **thread** is enough to hold a **signature** together, and a **crane** can lift what a hand cannot.” There was no **solution**, only a decision: a new line, which many of them preferred to most of the old ones. Her eye caught the remaining problem in it, but really there was no time.

中文翻译

那个小组无法控制的测试，以一张纸的形式到来。一项区域阅读调查将纳入他们的方法，而行政部门要求在本季度结束前给出决定。“我们谁都无法告诉彼此这会怎么结束，”曼雅说，“我们只能决定寄出什么。”一幅灰色的阅读槽图——他们自己幼稚的速写——摊在桌上官方表格的旁边，它的每一行看上去都不对。

调查的总体是一百万名学生，而他们的样本只有几百人。“相当坦率地说，那是很大的噪声，”校长说，“你们最好的希望是一个小而干净的结果。”他们每个人早就知道这一点。每一种分类都有它的边缘，而他们的边缘就是这张纸的边。至少他们可以事先说明这一点。

他们决定寄出方法本身，而不是结果。一条垂直线、一个签名、一枚图章和一捆绳子装进一个包裹，看上去更像一套戏服而不是一份提案。“如果调查什么都没发现，”林伟写道，“那也是一种确认，而不是灾难。”怀疑的火花仍在，但赞同的合唱比怀疑更响。

他们为一个措辞讨论了一个小时。把旧版本扔掉很诱人，但延续不是拒绝；它是在木地板下加进一根钢梁。“去翻附录吧，”曼雅说，“一个孩子画里的大熊猫、狼和龙，教给我们的东西比这项调查能教的还多。”水龙头在滴水，没人去关它。

一张白纸片、一片有机农场的叶子，以及一小瓶液体，是他们在学期最后一晚的全部所有物。“你是你自己报告里的英雄，”赵教授说，“而这恰恰是问题所在。”他们中有几个人沉默地坐着，有些人朝其他志愿者笑了笑。“就算如此，你们的时间很少，”她接着说，“但一根线就足以把签名固定住，而起重机能举起手举不起的东西。”没有解决方案，只有一个决定：一条新的线，他们中许多人更喜欢它，胜过大多数旧的线。她的眼睛看出了其中残留的问题，但说实话，已经没有时间了。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
know neu POS: v	v. 知道, 了解, 认识, 确信 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the fact of being aware of information that is known to few people; v. be cognizant or aware of a fact or a...
tell tel POS: vt	vt. 告诉, 说, 吩咐, 断定, 知道; vi. 讲述, 泄密, 告发, 表明 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a Swiss patriot who lived in the early 14th century and who was renowned for his skill as an archer; accor...
lot lot POS: n	n. 运气, 签, 抽签, 份额, 许多, 一堆; vt. 划分; vi. 抽签, 抓阄 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a parcel of land having fixed boundaries; n. (Old Testament) nephew of Abraham; God destroyed Sodom and Gom...
white hwait POS: n	n. 白色, 洁白, 眼白, 白种人, 蛋白; a. 白色的, 纯洁的, 白种的, 苍白的, 空白的, 幸运的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a member of the Caucasoid race; n. the quality or state of the achromatic color of greatest lightness (bear...
best best POS: a	a. 最好的; adv. 最好地; n. 最好的人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the supreme effort one can make; n. the person who is most outstanding or excellent; someone who tops all o...
pound paund POS: n	n. 磅, 英镑, 重击, 鱼塘, 拘留所, 兽栏; vt. 强烈打击, 捣烂, 监禁, 关入栏内; vi. 连续重击, 苦干 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. 16 ounces avoirdupois; n. a unit of apothecary weight equal to 12 ounces troy; n. a nontechnical unit of for...
administration əd.mini'streiʃən POS: n	n. 行政, 管理, 政府机关; [化] 给药 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a method of tending to or managing the affairs of a some group of people (especially the group's business...
population ˌpopju'leiʃən POS: n	n. 人口, 人口数; [化] 群体; 总体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the people who inhabit a territory or state; n. a group of organisms of the same species inhabiting a given...
discuss dis'kʌs POS: vt	vt. 讨论, 论述; [医] 讨论, 辩论 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an athletic competition in which a disk-shaped object is thrown as far as possible; n. a disk used in throwin...
throw θrəu POS: vt	vt. 投, 掷, 抛, 发射, 摔下, 匆匆穿上(或脱下), 抛弃, 摆脱; vi. 丢, 掷, 抛; n. 投掷, 掷骰子, 冒险 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of throwing (propelling something with a rapid movement of the arm and wrist); n. a single chance o...
solution sə'lu:ʃən POS: n	n. 解决, 解答, 溶液; [化] 溶液 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a homogeneous mixture of two or more substances; frequently (but not necessarily) a liquid solution; n. a s...
quarter 'kwɔ:tə POS: n	n. 四分之一, 一刻钟, 季度, 地区; vt. 四等分, 肢解; vi. 驻扎, 住宿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a district of a city having some distinguishing character; n. (football, professional basketball) one of fo...
none nʌn POS: adv	adv. 一点也不, 毫不; pron. 没有人, 无一物, 并无一个; a. 没有的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a canonical hour that is the ninth hour of the day counting from sunrise; n. a service in the Roman Catholi...
leaf li:f POS: n	n. 叶, 树叶, 花瓣, 页; vi. 生叶, 翻书页; vt. 在...上长叶, 翻...的页 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the main organ of photosynthesis and transpiration in higher plants; n. a sheet of any written or printed m...
reading 'ri:diŋ POS: n	n. 阅读, 知识, 读物; a. 阅读的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cognitive process of understanding a written linguistic message; n. a particular interpretation or perf...
slip slip POS: n	n. 滑, 滑行, 事故, 溜, 差错, 滑台, 下降, 插条, 后裔, 板条, 瘦长的年轻人; vi. 滑动, 滑倒, 失足, 溜走, 滑... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a minor inadvertent mistake usually observed in speech or writing or in small accidents or memory lapses e...
tank tæŋk POS: n	n. 槽, 箱, 柜, 罐, 池塘, 储水池, 坦克; vt. 储于箱中 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an enclosed armored military vehicle; has a cannon and moves on caterpillar treads; n. a large (usually met...
drawing 'drou:ŋ POS: n	n. 图画, 制图, 拉; [计] 绘图 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an illustration that is drawn by hand and published in a book, magazine, or newspaper; n. a representation...
grey grei POS: n	n. 灰色; a. 灰色的, 阴沉的; v. (使)成灰色 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. United States writer of western adventure novels (1875-1939); n. Queen of England for nine days in 1553; sh...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
hero 'hiərəu POS: n	n. 英雄, 超越常人者, 男主角 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a man distinguished by exceptional courage and nobility and strength; n. the principal character in a play...
steel sti:l POS: n	n. 钢, 钢制品, 钢铁, 坚硬, 坚固; a. 钢的, 钢制的, 钢铁业的, 坚强的; vt. 使坚强, 钢化, 使冷酷 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an alloy of iron with small amounts of carbon; widely used in construction; mechanical properties can be v...
principal 'prinsipəl POS: n	n. 校长, 首长, 本金, 主犯, 资本, 委托人; a. 主要的, 最重要的, 首要的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the original amount of a debt on which interest is calculated; n. the educator who has executive authority...
frank fræŋk POS: a	a. 坦白的, 率直的, 老实的; vt. 免费邮寄; n. 免费邮寄特权 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a member of the ancient Germanic peoples who spread from the Rhine into the Roman Empire in the 4th century...
tap 'tæp POS: n	n. 轻打, 水龙头; vt. 轻打, 轻敲, 敲打出, 选择, 装上嘴子, 使流出, 开发, 分接, 向...乞讨; vi. 轻叩, 轻拍, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small metal plate that attaches to the toe or heel of a shoe (as in tap dancing); n. a tool for cutting f...
organic o:'gænik POS: a	a. 器官的, 有机的, 组织的, 根本的; [医] 器官的, 有生命的, 有机的, 器质的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fertilizer that is derived from animal or vegetable matter; a. relating or belonging to the class of chem...
beam bi:m POS: n	n. 横梁, 杆, 光线, 容光焕发; vi. 用梁支承, 微笑, 射出光线; vt. 照耀, 感到欣喜; [计] 束 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. long thick piece of wood or metal or concrete, etc., used in construction; n. a group of nearly parallel li...
classification ,klæsifi'keɪʃən POS: n	n. 分类, 分级; [化] 分级; 分粒; 分类 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of people or things arranged by class or category; n. the basic cognitive process of arranging into...
signature 'signetʃə POS: n	n. 签字, 识别标志, 调号; [计] 签名附件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. your name written in your own handwriting; n. a melody used to identify a performer or a dance band or radi...
vertical 'vɜ:tɪkl POS: a	a. 垂直的, 直立的; [医] 垂直的, 顶的, 头顶的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that is oriented vertically; a. at right angles to the plane of the horizon or a base line; a. rel...
stamp stæmp POS: n	n. 印, 邮票, 打印机, 戳子, 图章, 印花税票, 标志, 特征, 类型, 跺脚; vt. 盖章于, 顿足, 贴上邮票, 铭刻, 捣碎... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a type or class; n. a symbol that is the result of printing or engraving; n. machine consisting of a heavy b...
wolf wulf POS: n	n. 狼, 残忍贪婪之人, 极度穷困; vt. 狼吞虎咽, 大吃 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of various predatory carnivorous canine mammals of North America and Eurasia that usually hunt in pack...
costume 'kɒstju:m POS: n	n. 装束, 服装 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the attire worn in a play or at a fancy dress ball; n. unusual or period attire not characteristic of or ap...
cord kɔ:d POS: n	n. 绳索, 束缚; [医] 索, 带 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a line made of twisted fibers or threads; n. a unit of amount of wood cut for burning; 128 cubic feet; n. a...
liquid 'likwid POS: n	n. 液体, 流体, 流音; a. 液体的, 透明的, 明亮的, 流动的, 易变的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a substance that is liquid at room temperature and pressure; n. the state in which a substance exhibits a c...
thread θred POS: n	n. 线, 丝, 纤维, 线索; vt. 穿线于, 穿过, 通过, 用线穿成; vi. 穿过; [计] 线索, 线程 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fine cord of twisted fibers (of cotton or silk or wool or nylon etc.) used in sewing and weaving; v. pass...
spark spɑ:k POS: n	n. 火花, 火星, 闪光, 无线电报务员, 瞬间放电, 活力, 朝气, 花花公子, 情郎; vi. 闪光, 发火花, 求婚; vt. 发动, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small but noticeable trace of some quality that might become stronger; n. Scottish writer of satirical no...
dragon 'dræɡən POS: n	n. 龙, 凶暴的人; [法] 凶恶的人, 凶恶严厉的监护人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a creature of Teutonic mythology; usually represented as breathing fire and having a reptilian body and so...
confirmation ,kɒnfə'meɪʃən POS: n	n. 证实, 证明, 批准, 确认; [计] 确认 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. additional proof that something that was believed (some fact or hypothesis or theory) is correct; n. inform...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
chorus 'kɔːrəs POS: n	n. 合唱队, 齐声; v. 齐声说道, 合唱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any utterance produced simultaneously by a group; n. a group of people assembled to sing together; n. a body...
continuation kən.tɪnju'eɪʃən POS: n	n. 继续, 续集, 补编; [医] 连续 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of continuing an activity without interruption; n. a part added to a book or play that continues and...
crane kreɪn POS: n	n. 鹤, 起重机; vt. 伸颈, 起重机起吊; vi. 伸颈看, 迟疑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. United States writer (1871–1900); n. United States poet (1899–1932); n. lifts and moves heavy objects; lifti...
belongings bɪ'lɒŋɪŋz POS: n	n. 财产, 所有物, 相关事物; [经] 财产, 所有物, 附属物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something owned; any tangible or intangible possession that is owned by someone; ; n. happiness felt in a sec...
browse braʊz POS: v	v. 浏览, 吃草; n. 浏览, 吃草; [计] 浏览 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. vegetation (such as young shoots, twigs, and leaves) that is suitable for animals to eat; n. reading superf...
panda 'pændə POS: n	n. 大熊猫, 小熊猫 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. large black-and-white herbivorous mammal of bamboo forests of China and Tibet; in some classifications cons...
granted phonetic unavailable POS: adv	adv. 算是如此, 但是 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. let have; v. give as judged due or on the basis of merit; v. be willing to concede; v. allow to have; v. bestow, es...